



Rating
Hold

North America
United States

TMT
Software

Company
Adobe

Reuters
ADBE.OQ

Bloomberg
ADBE US

Date
11 September 2026

Rating	Hold
Price target (USD)	260.00
Price at 10 Sep 26	248.83
52-week range	367.46 – 8.55

[Valuation & Risks](#)

F3Q - Solid quarter, but the picture is still rendering

Adobe reported a solid F3Q, but we don't expect results or encouraging leading indicators will be sufficient to resolve persistent debates overhanging the stock. Top-line and segment-level revenues were ahead, though Total ARR of \$27.5bn was only in line with the Street and FY ARR guidance was maintained. CEO-designate Anil Chakravarthy's thoughts on the company's future outlook highlighted vast opportunity across the entire Adobe portfolio and customer base, possibly a bit different from what some might have expected to be a more narrow focus on enterprise. We look forward to learning more in the coming months about Mr. Chakravarthy's vision for Adobe.

AI KPIs and other leading indicators were once again encouraging. AI-first ARR surpassed \$650mn up ~\$150mn sequentially and accelerating from ~\$100mn added last quarter. Firefly enterprise usage accelerated and Firefly app and credit pack ending ARR grew 40% q/q, all of which we believe reflects accelerating adoption and usage of Adobe's AI solutions. Creative freemium MAUs exceeded 100 million, while Acrobat AI Assistant MAU doubled quarter over quarter, and total Acrobat + Express MAU surpassed 900mn. All of these point towards continued freemium momentum, though the timeline to monetization remains a key question.

F4Q guidance was roughly in line with Street estimates, though the 1-2pt sequential deceleration underscores questions around go-forward growth. We note Adobe will have an extra week in F1Q and FY27 which we believe should benefit revenue by ~\$500mn with likely a more modest tailwind to F1Q NNARR of ~\$30mn, and may not be well reflected in Street models. While results were solid and commentary on growth initiatives encouraging, we expect the positives are insufficient to outweigh broader go-forward uncertainty. Maintain Hold and \$260 Target Price.

What we liked/What we're watching on results

(+) F3Q total revenue of \$6.76bn was ahead of Street expectations of approximately \$6.70bn, growing 13% y/y (12% cc).

(=) Total ARR exited the quarter at \$27.50bn, in line with Street expectations and grew 11.2% y/y reported, and we estimate ~9% organically. Net new ARR of ~\$400mn likely reflects postponed Creative Cloud line optimizations and greater emphasis on freemium user acquisition.

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(+) Business Professionals & Consumers subscription revenue of \$1.91bn grew 16% y/y (15% cc), ahead of Street \$1.88bn. Acrobat + Express MAU surpassed 900mn and grew more than 25% y/y, while Acrobat AI Assistant MAU doubled q/q. Adobe surpassed 1bn total MAU, growing more than 20% y/y, while creative freemium MAU crossed 100mn and grew more than 70% y/y.

(+) Creative & Marketing Professionals subscription revenue of \$4.65bn grew 13% y/y (12% cc), modestly ahead of Street \$4.63bn. Continued strength was noted in Creative Cloud Teams and Enterprise, alongside >20% ARR growth across each of AEM & agentic web apps, GenStudio and AEP & apps.

(+) AI monetization continued to progress, with AI-first ending ARR exceeding \$650mn and growing more than 150% y/y, up from >\$500mn last quarter. Firefly App and credit-pack ARR grew 40% q/q, while credit consumption accelerated q/q across Creative Cloud and the Firefly App.

(=) Non-GAAP operating margin of 44.0% was in line with Street estimates. Non-GAAP EPS of \$6.14 was modestly ahead of Street expectations, benefitting from better than anticipated top-line and ongoing share repurchases.

(-) RPO grew 8% y/y and cRPO grew 9% y/y, decelerating from double-digit growth over the prior nine quarters as the company leans in on proliferating its freemium offerings.

(+) Adobe repurchased approximately 9.5mn shares for \$2.23bn vs 8.5mn shares for \$2.1bn last quarter and exited the quarter with \$24.6bn of repurchase authorization remaining.

[What we liked/What we're watching on guidance](#)

(=) FY26 ending ARR growth guidance was maintained at 10.2% y/y, implying approximately \$775mn of net new ARR in F4Q, consistent with Street expectations.

(=) F4Q total revenue guidance of \$6.80-6.85bn is roughly in-line Street expectations at the high end and implies roughly 10% y/y growth at the midpoint. Management expects modest FX headwinds for the quarter.

(-) F4Q Business Professionals & Consumers subscription revenue guidance of \$1.93-1.95bn was modestly below Street expectations and implies approximately 13% y/y growth at the midpoint, decelerating from 16% in F3Q.

(=) F4Q Creative & Marketing Professionals subscription revenue guidance of \$4.665-4.695bn brackets Street expectations and implies approximately 10% y/y growth at the midpoint, decelerating from 13% in 3Q. We estimate guidance implies ~7.5% y/y organic growth in 4Q, decelerating from 10.1% in 3Q likely as a result of postponed Creative Cloud line optimizations and leaning in on proliferating freemium offerings.

(=) F4Q non-GAAP operating margin guidance of approximately 44.0% is roughly in line with Street expectations. We estimate guidance embeds ~12% y/y OpEx growth vs 16% in 3Q and 14% in 2Q as the company absorbed Semrush. F4Q non-GAAP EPS guidance of \$6.30-6.35 is modestly better than Street expectations at the midpoint.



(=) We note Adobe will have an extra week in 1Q, which we estimate will add ~\$500-550mn in revenues, or ~8pts of growth to F1Q and 2pts of growth for FY27. From an ARR perspective, we expect the impact will be much less meaningful, possibly ~\$30mn in net new ARR, which adds ~10bps to 1Q and full-year ARR growth. This in turn creates challenging compares for F1Q and FY28.

Estimates, Risks, and Valuation

Following F3Q results, we adjust our FY26/27 revenue and EPS estimates to \$26.6bn/\$29.6bn and \$24.46/\$28.68 from \$26.6bn/\$29.1bn and \$24.41/\$28.42 respectively to reflect our updated views on the business and to reflect the extra week in 1Q and FY27. We maintain our Hold rating and our DCF-derived \$260 target price. Our DCF is based on a WACC of 12% and a terminal RFR of 4%. We use a terminal growth rate of 2%, reflecting sub-sector growth assumptions. Downside risks include: 1) competition from disruptors across different forms of creative media, 2) underperformance from Digital Experience, and 3) execution. Upside risks include: 1) accelerated contribution to financials from monetization of Firefly, 2) genAI unlocking greater than expected adoption of creative tools, and 3) Digital Media driving sooner than expected adoption of DX solutions.

Figure 1: F3Q Results

Adobe (ADBE)					
In \$mn except EPS					
	3Q26				
	Actual	DBe	Actual vs Est	Cons.	Company guidance
Income Statement					
Business Pros and Consumer	1,910	1,879		1,881	1,870-1,890
Y/Y Growth	+15.9%	+14.0%		+14.1%	
Creative and Marketing Pros	4,650	4,614		4,626	4,610-4,640
Y/Y Growth	+12.9%	+12.1%		+12.4%	
Other	200	196		188	
Y/Y Growth	-10.3%	-12.0%		-15.8%	
Total Revenue	6,760	6,689	+1.1%	6,695	6,670-6,720
Y/Y Growth	+12.9%	+11.7%		+11.8%	
Non-GAAP Gross Profit	6,050	6,006	+0.7%	6,009	
Y/Y Growth	+11.6%	+10.8%		+10.9%	
Non-GAAP GM (%)	89.5%	89.8%		89.8%	
Non-GAAP OI	2,974	2,943	+1.1%	2,946	
Y/Y Growth	+7.2%	+6.1%		+6.2%	
Non-GAAP OM (%)	44.0%	44.0%		44.0%	~44%
Non-GAAP Net Income	2,424	2,394	+1.2%	2,401	
Non-GAAP EPS	\$6.14	\$6.06	+1.3%	\$6.08	\$6.05-6.10
Y/Y Growth	+15.5%	+14.1%		+14.4%	
Operating Metrics					
Total ARR	27,500	27,517		27,503	
Y/Y Growth	+11.2%	+11.2%		+11.2%	
Incremental Total ARR	+400	+417		+403	
Y/Y Growth	-37.5%	-34.9%		-37.1%	
Operating Cash Flow	2,523	2,073	+21.7%	2,221	
Y/Y Growth	+14.8%	-5.7%		+1.0%	
Capex	85	74	+15.5%	71	
FCF	2,438	1,999	+22.0%	2,145	
Y/Y Growth	+14.7%	-6.0%		+0.9%	

Source: DB Research, Company Data, Bloomberg Finance LP



Figure 2: Estimate Revisions

Adobe (ADBE)											
In \$mn except EPS											
	4Q26E				FY26E				FY27E		
	DBe	Old estimates	Cons.	Company guidance	DBe	Old estimates	Cons.	Company guidance	DBe	Old estimates	Cons.
Income Statement											
Business Pros and Consumer	1,941	1,950	1,950	1,930-1,950	7,486	7,464	7,464	7,470-7,490	8,492	8,318	8,344
Y/Y Growth	+13.0%	+13.5%	+13.5%		+15.3%	+14.9%	+14.9%		+13.4%	+11.4%	+11.5%
Creative and Marketing Pros	4,683	4,707	4,683	4,665-4,695	18,259	18,247	18,247	18,242-18,272	20,304	19,966	19,784
Y/Y Growth	+10.3%	+10.9%	+10.3%		+12.0%	+11.9%	+11.9%		+11.2%	+9.4%	+8.3%
Other	204	203	215		859	855	849		785	781	792
Y/Y Growth	-11.5%	-12.0%	-6.8%		-11.5%	-12.0%	-12.6%		-8.6%	-8.6%	-7.8%
Total Revenue	6,829	6,860	6,848	6,800-6,850	26,605	26,565	26,561	\$26,576-26,626	29,580	29,065	28,920
Y/Y Growth	+10.3%	+10.8%	+10.6%		+11.9%	+11.8%	+11.7%		+11.2%	+9.4%	+8.9%
Non-GAAP Gross Profit	6,105	6,153	6,147		23,873	23,878	23,870		26,456	26,122	25,851
Y/Y Growth	+9.0%	+9.9%	+9.8%		+11.1%	+11.1%	+11.1%		+10.8%	+9.4%	+8.3%
Non-GAAP GM (%)	89.4%	89.7%	89.8%		89.7%	89.9%	89.9%		89.4%	89.9%	89.4%
Non-GAAP OI	3,008	3,018	3,029		11,962	11,944	11,948		13,247	13,065	12,980
Y/Y Growth	+6.5%	+6.9%	+7.3%		+8.8%	8.7%	+8.7%		+10.7%	9.4%	+8.6%
Non-GAAP OM (%)	44.0%	44.0%	44.2%	~44%	45.0%	45.0%	45.0%	~45%	44.8%	45.0%	44.9%
Non-GAAP Net Income	2,452	2,459	2,453		9,764	9,745	9,740		10,760	10,625	10,281
Non-GAAP EPS	\$6.30	\$6.32	\$6.30	\$6.30-6.35	\$24.46	\$24.41	\$24.40	\$24.45-24.50	\$28.68	\$28.42	\$27.40
Y/Y Growth	+14.5%	+14.9%	+14.6%		+16.7%	+16.4%	+16.4%		+17.3%	+16.4%	+12.3%
Operating Metrics											
Total ARR	28,269	28,279	28,277		28,269	28,279	28,277		30,510	30,682	30,609
Y/Y Growth	+10.2%	+10.2%	+10.2%		+10.2%	+10.2%	+10.2%	+10.2%	+7.9%	+8.5%	+8.3%
Incremental Total ARR	769	762	777		2,609	2,619	2,617		2,241	2,404	2,341
Y/Y Growth	-16.4%	-17.2%	-15.5%		+0.7%	+1.1%	+1.1%		-14.1%	-8.2%	-10.3%
Operating Cash Flow	3,220	3,699	3,238		10,866	10,895	10,712		11,715	11,809	11,657
Y/Y Growth	+1.9%	+17.1%	+2.5%		+8.3%	8.6%	+6.8%		+7.8%	8.4%	+8.8%
Capex	75	75	62		255	244	227		325	320	290
FCF	3,144	3,623	3,177		10,610	10,650	10,446		11,389	11,489	11,337
Y/Y Growth	+0.6%	+15.9%	+1.6%		+7.7%	8.1%	+6.0%		+7.3%	7.9%	+8.5%

Source: DB Research, Company Data, Bloomberg Finance LP



Appendix 1

Important Disclosures

Company	Ticker	Recent price	Disclosure
Adobe	ADBE.OQ	248.83 (USD) 10 Sep 26	8, 15

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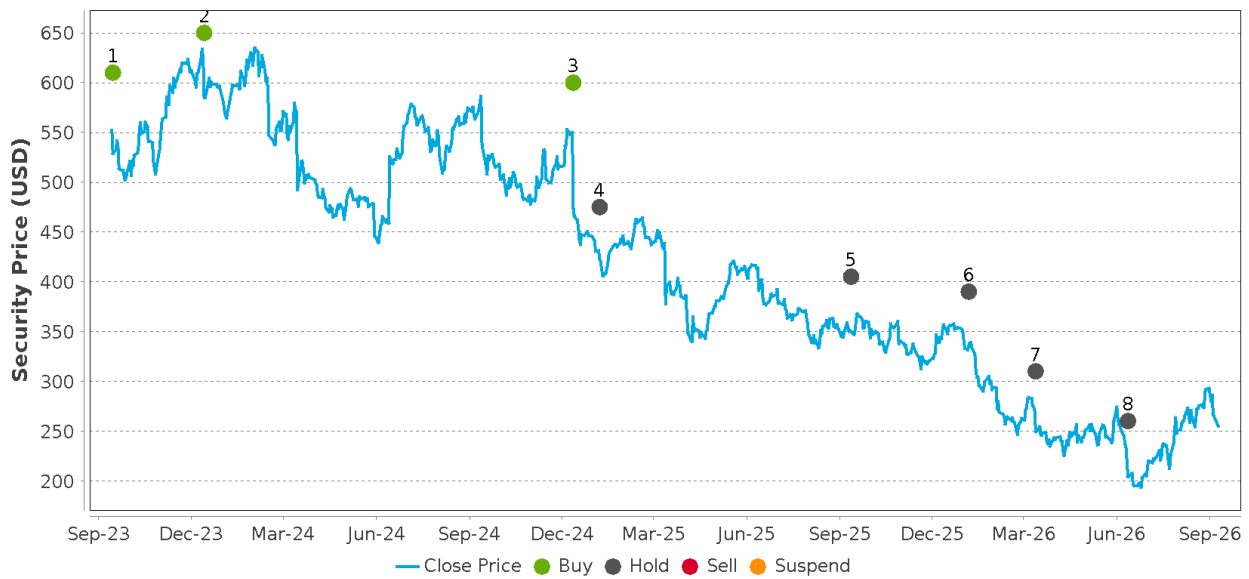
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Historical recommendations and target price: Adobe (ADBE.OQ)



1.	15 Sep 23	Price target: 610 (USD), close price 528.89 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Brad Zelnick
2.	14 Dec 23	Price target: 650 (USD), close price 584.64 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Brad Zelnick
3.	12 Dec 24	Price target: 600 (USD), close price 474.63 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Brad Zelnick
4.	7 Jan 25	Price target: 475 (USD), close price 422.63 (USD), Recommendation: Hold, Analyst: Brad Zelnick
5.	12 Sep 25	Price target: 405 (USD), close price 349.36 (USD), Recommendation: Hold, Analyst: Brad Zelnick
6.	6 Jan 26	Price target: 390 (USD), close price 335.99 (USD), Recommendation: Hold, Analyst: Brad Zelnick
7.	13 Mar 26	Price target: 310 (USD), close price 249.32 (USD), Recommendation: Hold, Analyst: Brad Zelnick
8.	12 Jun 26	Price target: 260 (USD), close price 204.02 (USD), Recommendation: Hold, Analyst: Brad Zelnick



Company rating dispersion and banking relationships

DBSI Companies under Coverage	Buy	Hold	Sell
Covered	58%	42%	0%
w/ Banking relationship	43%	35%	0%
w/ MiFID services	64%	52%	67%

Global Companies under Coverage	Buy	Hold	Sell
Covered	58%	40%	2%
w/ Banking relationship	46%	32%	31%
w/ MiFID services	75%	68%	92%

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Note - percentages are rounded so may not total 100%.

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TSR: Total Shareholder Return. Percentage change in share price from current price to projected target price plus projected dividend yield.

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